Waterfront clothing shop also came to the launch. After a few drinks, a few of us decided – as sometimes happens with a bunch of single guys – that it would make for an entertaining evening if we patronised one of the city's strip clubs.

We first went to the House of Rasputin, but couldn't find anyone there who really whet our appetites. So we decided to try Mavericks. Already well on our way, we got ourselves a little booth and carried on drinking in the company of some very pretty ladies. Many of them had Eastern European accents, as I recall. One of the guys in our group was a chap by the name of Brett Canterbury.

'Brett,' I said, 'come, you and I are going to double up. We are going to go in for a little lap dance.' Both of us were flying by then – it must've been almost 2 a.m., and we were all well past our sell-by-date. My wallet was on the couch next to me. Brett and I were soon on the receiving end of a great exhibition of the art of lap dancing. The girl took off my tie and my waistcoat and just left my shirt on. She undid my pants too.

For the record, I still had my jocks on. Funnily enough, my tie disappeared. When I eventually came out of the cubicle, I was sans tie. I never did figure out what had happened to it. I really liked that tie.

Anyway, so the next day I met another mate of mine for lunch at Col'Cacchio Pizzeria in Camps Bay. I took out my wallet and noticed the credit-card slip of the previous evening … R6 000. This was a helluva lot, but the guys and I had had a great time and, as I often do, I had picked up the tab. 'Phew,' I said to my mate. 'I was out with a couple of buddies at Mavericks last night. Top evening, but it was a little pricey. I really need to stop picking up the bill all the time.'

Then I noticed *another* credit-card slip from Mavericks for … wait for it … R15 000. Fifteen grand, I kid you not. I got the fright of my life. There was no way I would've knowingly dropped that kind of cash.

As I've mentioned, there's only one person I call when I've landed in the shit, and that's my long-suffering manager, Donné. Something definitely smelt off here. Besides the fact that I would not have spent so much, I would also not have spent so much in such a short space of time. On the R6 000 tab, the time read 02h30. But on the R15 000 tab, the time was 03h15. I mean, how do you spend 15K at a strip club in 45 minutes? All we'd had were drinks and a lap dance.